

```

    # Movement flag; start with a ship that's not moving.
    ❶ self.moving_right = False

    ❷ def update(self):
        """Update the ship's position based on the movement flag."""
        if self.moving_right:
            self.rect.x += 1

    def blitme(self):
        --snip--

```

---

We add a `self.moving_right` attribute in the `__init__()` method and set it to `False` initially ❶. Then we add `update()`, which moves the ship right if the flag is `True` ❷. The `update()` method will be called from outside the class, so it's not considered a helper method.

Now we need to modify `_check_events()` so that `moving_right` is set to `True` when the right arrow key is pressed and `False` when the key is released:

```

alien
_invasion.py

def _check_events(self):
    """Respond to keypresses and mouse events."""
    for event in pygame.event.get():
        --snip--
        elif event.type == pygame.KEYDOWN:
            if event.key == pygame.K_RIGHT:
                ❶ self.ship.moving_right = True
                ❷ elif event.type == pygame.KEYUP:
                    if event.key == pygame.K_RIGHT:
                        self.ship.moving_right = False

```

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Here, we modify how the game responds when the player presses the right arrow key: instead of changing the ship's position directly, we merely set `moving_right` to `True` ❶. Then we add a new `elif` block, which responds to `KEYUP` events ❷. When the player releases the right arrow key (`K_RIGHT`), we set `moving_right` to `False`.

Next, we modify the `while` loop in `run_game()` so it calls the ship's `update()` method on each pass through the loop:

```

alien_invasion.py

def run_game(self):
    """Start the main loop for the game."""
    while True:
        self._check_events()
        self.ship.update()
        self._update_screen()
        self.clock.tick(60)

```

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The ship's position will be updated after we've checked for keyboard events and before we update the screen. This allows the ship's position to be updated in response to player input and ensures the updated position will be used when drawing the ship to the screen.

When you run `alien_invasion.py` and hold down the right arrow key, the ship should move continuously to the right until you release the key.